

Annual survey syntax port

Carry a year of statistical code forward without carrying its bugs.

PROCEDURE WRITTEN · USED ON THE CURRENT YEAR

SCHEMATIC

YEAR N-1

Production syntax
Known variable names
Proven output



YEAR N

Renamed variables
New categories
A question that moved

Profile first, carry across mechanically, prove before anyone trusts a table.

4

PHASES: PROFILE, PORT,
PROVE, LOG

2

YEARS COMPARED PER RUN

Logged

EVERY DEVIATION

Proof

REQUIRED BEFORE HANDOFF

WHAT IT IS

Every survey year arrives with a slightly different file: renamed variables, new categories, a question that moved. This is the written procedure for porting the previous year's production syntax onto it - profile the new file against the prior one first, carry the syntax across mechanically, then prove the port before anyone trusts a table from it.

WHAT IT CHANGES

Differences between years are found before the code runs, not after a table looks odd

The port is mechanical, so the reviewer checks decisions rather than typing

Every deviation ends up in a work log instead of somebody's memory

SPSS syntax · R profiling · written procedure

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SOMETHING LIKE THIS, FOR YOUR WORK?

The interesting part is your version of the problem.

Tell me the workflow that costs you the most time or the most trust. I will tell you honestly whether a system fixes it.

Start a conversation